PublishLens

User guide

by Phani Vanga · Version 1.0 · November 2026

PublishLens reads the publishing logs from Windchill visualization workers and shows how many documents were published, which failed, why they failed, and where the time goes. It runs only on your own computer. It needs no internet connection, sends nothing anywhere, and uses no AI service.

PublishLens is free to use. If you need help, want a change, or find a problem, see **Support and feedback** at the end of this guide.

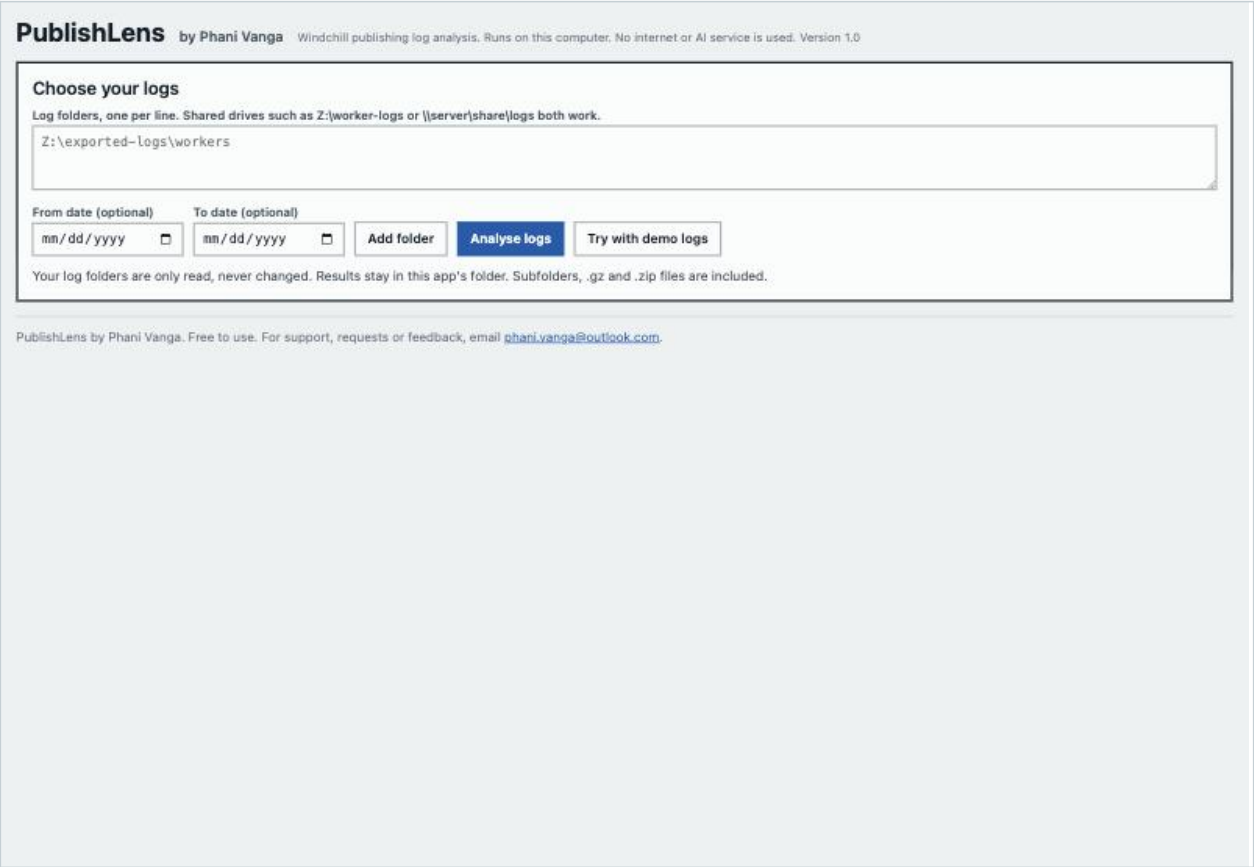
1. What you need

Item	Details
Computer	Windows 10 or Windows 11. No installation rights or Python are needed.
Logs	Worker logs exported to a folder you can open, on your PC or a shared drive. Helper and monitor logs are optional but add a cross-check.
Browser	Edge, Chrome or Firefox. PublishLens opens in your browser but stays on your PC.

2. Install PublishLens

1. Download **PublishLens-1.0-Windows.zip** from the Releases section of the PublishLens GitHub page.
2. Right-click the ZIP and choose **Properties**. If you see **Unblock**, tick it and click **OK**.
3. Right-click the ZIP and choose **Extract All**. Extract it to a local folder such as `C:\PublishLens`, not to a shared drive.
4. Open the folder and double-click **PublishLens.exe**.
5. Windows may show **Windows protected your PC**, because PublishLens is not signed by a publisher. If your company policy allows it, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Ask your IT team if you are unsure.
6. A black window opens, and then PublishLens opens in your browser. **Keep the black window open** while you use PublishLens. Close it to stop PublishLens.

To try PublishLens before using your own logs, click **Try with demo logs**. Demo results show an orange **DEMO LOGS** banner and are made-up test data.



The start page. Enter or add your log folders, then click Analyse logs.

3. Prepare your logs

Export the logs to one folder, with one subfolder for each worker server. The subfolder name becomes the server name in the results.

```
Z:\publish-logs\officeworker01\
Z:\publish-logs\officeworker02\
Z:\publish-logs\cadworker01\
```

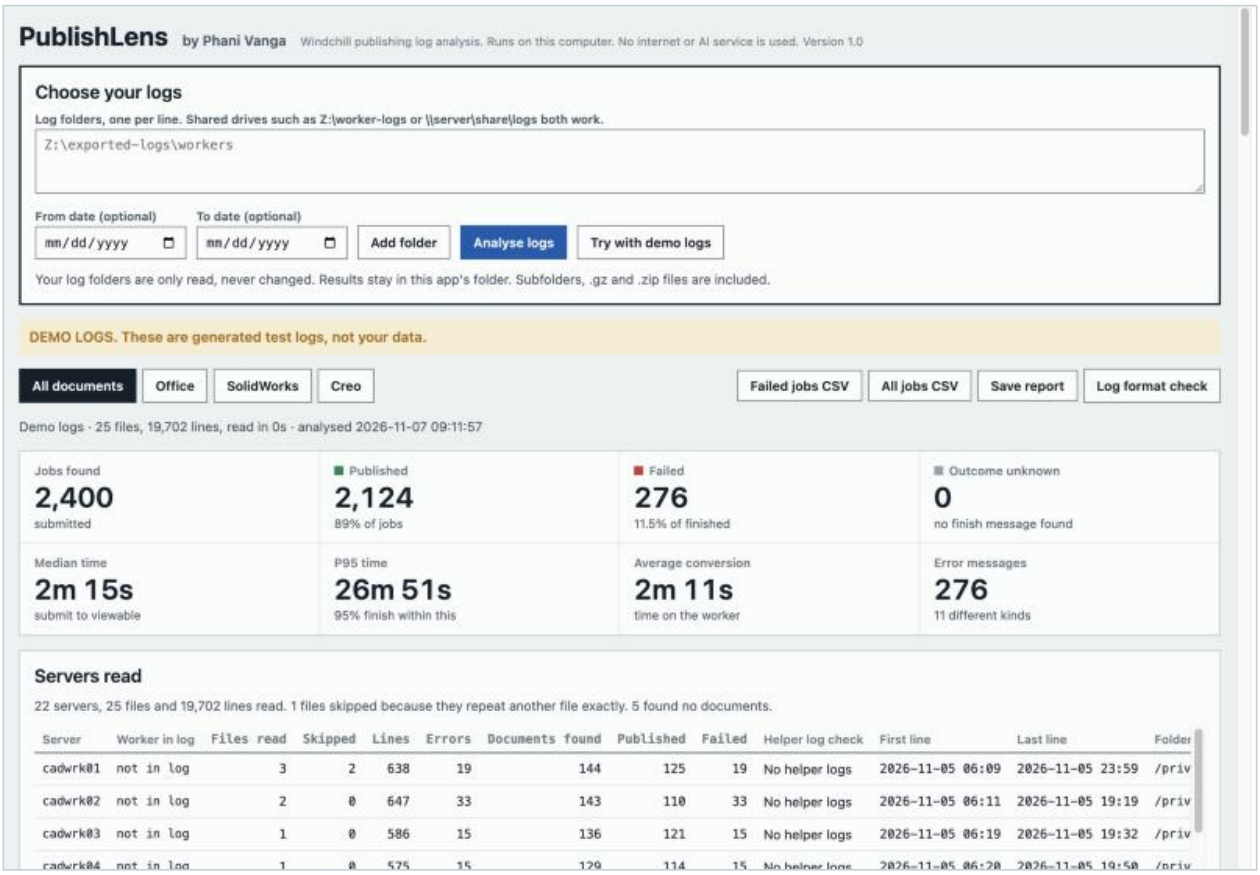
Log	File names	What it adds
Worker log	worker_1.log, worker_2.log ...	Each conversion, its document, result and time. Required.
Helper log	helper_1.log, helper_2.log ...	A second count of jobs sent and finished, used as a cross-check.
Monitor log	monitor_1.log ...	When workers were started and stopped.
Method server logs	MethodServer and BackgroundMethodServer logs	Time spent waiting in the publish queue. Optional.

PublishLens also reads subfolders, .gz files and .zip files. It only reads your logs and never changes, moves or deletes them.

4. Analyse your logs

1. Click **Add folder**. Choose a drive, open the folder that holds the logs, and click **Add this folder**. The window shows how many log files each folder holds.
2. Repeat for each server, or add the parent folder once to include all its subfolders. Then click **Done**.
3. You can also type or paste folders, one per line. Network paths such as `\\server\share\logs` work.
4. Optional: choose a **From date** and **To date** to analyse only part of the logs.
5. Click **Analyse logs**. A progress bar shows the files being read.
6. Check the banner. Your own results show a green **REAL DATA** banner with your folders, the number of files and lines, and the dates the logs cover.

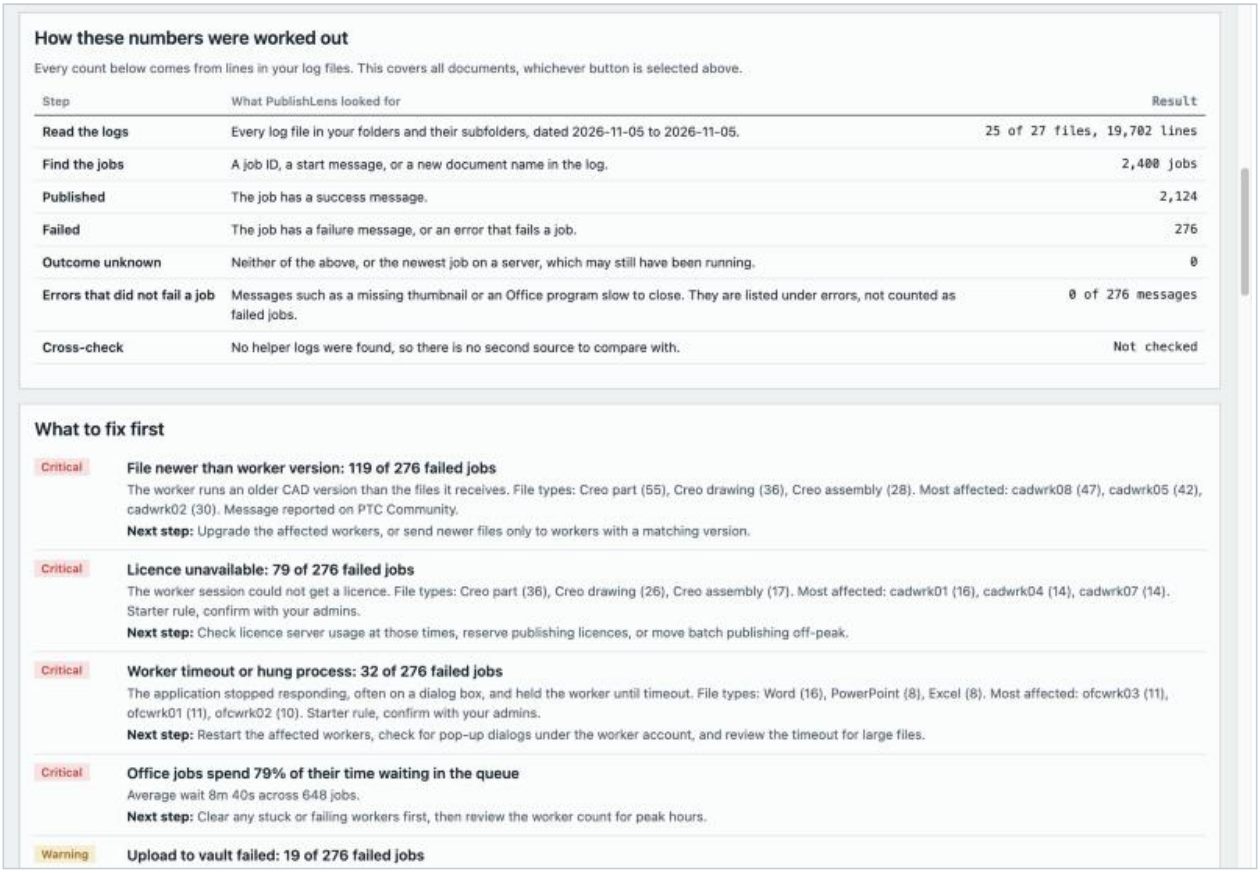
5. Read the results



The top of the results, shown here with demo logs. Use the buttons above the numbers to show one product at a time.

Section	What it shows
Summary numbers	Jobs found, published, failed and outcome unknown, with typical and slowest times.
Servers read	Each server's files, lines, documents and failures, plus the worker name found in the log. **Counts match** means the helper logs agree with the worker logs.
How these numbers were worked out	What PublishLens looked for at each step, with one real published job and one real failed job from your logs, including line numbers.
What to fix first	The most important problems, each with a likely cause and a suggested next step.
Status by document type	Published and failed jobs for each file type, such as Word, Excel and PDF.
Jobs per day or hour	When jobs ran and when failures happened.
Why jobs failed	Failure reasons. Select one to see its failed jobs and the log lines for each job.
Workers and servers	Each worker's jobs, failures and times, so problem workers stand out.

Section	What it shows
Error messages, grouped	Similar messages are grouped together, with how often and where they appeared.
Log files read	Every file, whether it was read, skipped or could not be opened.



How these numbers were worked out

Every count below comes from lines in your log files. This covers all documents, whichever button is selected above.

Step	What PublishLens looked for	Result
Read the logs	Every log file in your folders and their subfolders, dated 2026-11-05 to 2026-11-05.	25 of 27 files, 19,702 lines
Find the jobs	A job ID, a start message, or a new document name in the log.	2,400 jobs
Published	The job has a success message.	2,124
Failed	The job has a failure message, or an error that fails a job.	276
Outcome unknown	Neither of the above, or the newest job on a server, which may still have been running.	0
Errors that did not fail a job	Messages such as a missing thumbnail or an Office program slow to close. They are listed under errors, not counted as failed jobs.	0 of 276 messages
Cross-check	No helper logs were found, so there is no second source to compare with.	Not checked

What to fix first

Critical **File newer than worker version: 119 of 276 failed jobs**
The worker runs an older CAD version than the files it receives. File types: Creo part (55), Creo drawing (36), Creo assembly (28). Most affected: cadwrk08 (47), cadwrk05 (42), cadwrk02 (30). Message reported on PTC Community.
Next step: Upgrade the affected workers, or send newer files only to workers with a matching version.

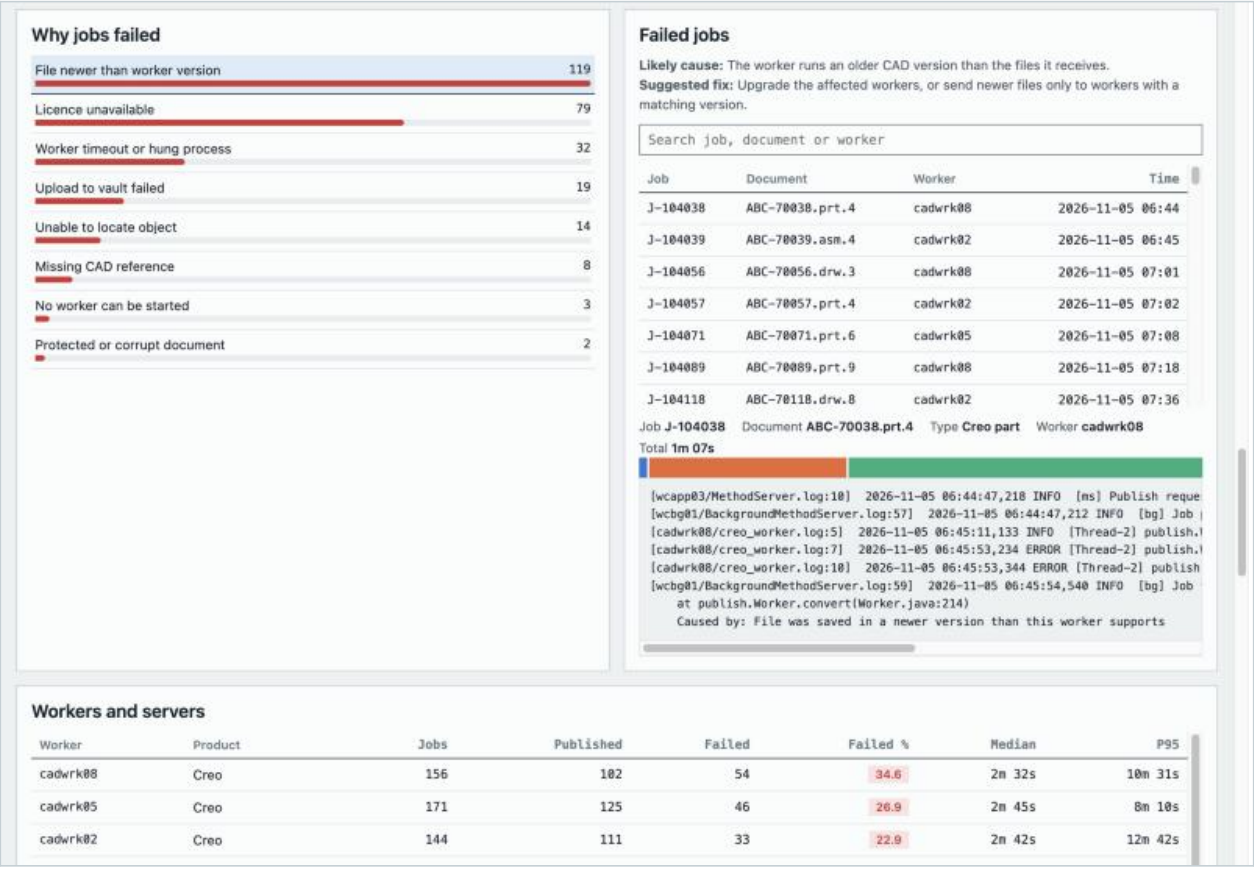
Critical **Licence unavailable: 79 of 276 failed jobs**
The worker session could not get a licence. File types: Creo part (36), Creo drawing (26), Creo assembly (17). Most affected: cadwrk01 (16), cadwrk04 (14), cadwrk07 (14). Starter rule, confirm with your admins.
Next step: Check licence server usage at those times, reserve publishing licences, or move batch publishing off-peak.

Critical **Worker timeout or hung process: 32 of 276 failed jobs**
The application stopped responding, often on a dialog box, and held the worker until timeout. File types: Word (16), PowerPoint (8), Excel (8). Most affected: ofcwrk03 (11), ofcwrk01 (11), ofcwrk02 (10). Starter rule, confirm with your admins.
Next step: Restart the affected workers, check for pop-up dialogs under the worker account, and review the timeout for large files.

Critical **Office jobs spend 79% of their time waiting in the queue**
Average wait 8m 40s across 648 jobs.
Next step: Clear any stuck or failing workers first, then review the worker count for peak hours.

Warning **Upload to vault failed: 19 of 276 failed jobs**

How these numbers were worked out, and What to fix first, shown with demo logs.



Why jobs failed. Select a reason, then a job, to see the log lines PublishLens used.

6. How PublishLens decides

PublishLens follows fixed rules written into the program. The same logs always give the same results. For Office workers that use doc2pv, it works like this:

Result	Rule
A job	Each `Recipe file:` line starts one conversion. The next `Source file:` line names the document.
Published	The job reached `Generating Output : COMPLETE`.
Failed	`Failed to publish document`, `Received signal`, or no end before the next job or the end of the log.
Outcome unknown	None of the above, or the newest job on a server, which may still have been running when the logs were copied.
Not a failure	Messages such as a missing thumbnail or an Office program slow to close are listed as errors, but they do not count as failed jobs.
Time	From the start of a conversion to Generating Output. Queue wait needs method server logs.

Each failure reason has a likely cause and a suggested fix. These are starting points for your Windchill administrator to confirm, not final answers.

7. Save and share results

- Every analysis is saved in the **reports** folder next to PublishLens.exe, as **report.html** and **failed_jobs.csv**.
- **Save report** downloads a single HTML file that opens in any browser without PublishLens.
- **Failed jobs CSV** and **All jobs CSV** open in Excel.
- **Log format check** saves a text file showing how your logs are worded, with document names and paths masked. Send it when your logs are not read correctly. Read it before sending, because masking cannot catch every name.

Reports contain real document names and log lines. Treat them as confidential and follow your company's rules before sharing them.

8. Privacy and safety

- PublishLens works only on your computer. Other computers cannot connect to it.
- It does not use the internet or any AI service, and it sends no data anywhere.
- It only reads your log folders. Results are saved in the PublishLens folder.

9. Limits of version 1.0

- Office worker logs from doc2pv have been checked against real logs.
- Creo and SolidWorks worker logs are supported with general rules, but have not yet been checked against real logs. Results for them may show Outcome unknown until their wording is added.
- Worker logs alone cannot show how long jobs waited in the queue.
- PublishLens shows what the logs say. Check important findings with your Windchill administrator.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Windows protected your PC	Click More info, then Run anyway, if your company allows it. Otherwise ask IT.
The browser does not open	Look in the black window for the address, such as http://127.0.0.1:8765/, and open it in your browser. If that port is busy, PublishLens uses the next one.

Problem	What to do
A folder shows no log files	Open the folder that holds the .log files. Add folder lists folders, and shows the number of log files in the folder that is open.
A server is missing in Servers read	Check the folder path and that you can open it in File Explorer.
Counts differ in Servers read	The worker and helper logs may cover different dates. Export both for the same period.
Many jobs show Outcome unknown	Your logs may use wording PublishLens does not know yet. Send a Log format check file.
Results still show DEMO LOGS	Add your folders and click Analyse logs.

11. Support and feedback

PublishLens is made by **Phani Vanga**. For help, requests or problems, email **phani.vanga@outlook.com**.

- **Comments:** open an Issue on the PublishLens GitHub page.
- **Requests:** describe what you need and, if possible, attach a Log format check file.
- **New versions:** changes are made by the author and released as a new installer.

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